

THE GOSPEL VAULT

The Feasts of the Lord Fulfilled in Christ

The Seven Appointed Times of Leviticus 23 and What They Reveal About the Messiah's First and Second Comings

Translation: New American Standard Bible (NASB 1995)

Scripture links: Blue Letter Bible (NASB95)

Source: The Gospel Vault

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Introduction: The Lord's Appointed Times

PROPOSITION

The seven feasts God gave Israel in Leviticus 23 are not merely agricultural holidays or national memorials. The New Testament treats them as a prophetic calendar — “a mere shadow of what is to come” whose substance “belongs to Christ.” The four spring feasts were fulfilled in the Messiah’s death, burial, resurrection, and sending of the Spirit; the three fall feasts look ahead to His return, Israel’s national restoration, and His kingdom reign.

When God spoke to Moses about Israel’s holy days, He did not call them Israel’s feasts. He called them His own: “The LORD’S appointed times which you shall proclaim as holy convocations — My appointed times are these” ([Leviticus 23:2](#)).ⁱ The Hebrew word *mo’adim* means appointed times or fixed meetings — dates on the calendar God Himself set to meet with His people. Seven of them are laid out in a single chapter, in the order the agricultural year unfolds: four in the spring, a long summer harvest, and three in the fall.

For fifteen centuries Israel kept these feasts in faith and gratitude, mostly without knowing that each one was also a picture. The Apostle Paul, writing to Gentile believers who were being pressured to keep the festival calendar, explains what those pictures were for:

Therefore no one is to act as your judge in regard to food or drink or in respect to a festival or a new moon or a Sabbath day — things which are a mere shadow of what is to come; but the substance belongs to Christ.

— **Colossians 2:16–17 (NASB95)**

A shadow is real, but it is not the thing itself. It has the outline of the body that casts it, and it always arrives first. That is what the feasts are: accurate outlines, cast ahead in time, of a Person and a work that was still to come. This paper walks through each of the seven, asking two questions of each: what did the feast mean to Israel, and how does the New Testament say it is fulfilled in Jesus the Messiah?

A word about method. Some connections between the feasts and Christ are made explicitly by the New Testament writers themselves — Passover ([1 Corinthians 5:7](#)), First Fruits ([1 Corinthians 15:20](#)), Pentecost ([Acts 2:1](#)), the Day of Atonement ([Hebrews 9](#)), and Tabernacles ([John 7:37–39](#)). Others, especially the prophetic meaning of the fall feasts, are inferences drawn from the overall pattern and from the Old Testament prophets. This paper tries to be honest about the difference. The framework followed here is the dispensational one developed at length by Messianic Jewish and dispensational writers,ⁱⁱⁱⁱ in which the spring feasts were fulfilled at Christ’s first coming and the fall feasts await His second.^{iv}

I. Passover — The Lamb Slain

The Shadow

Passover comes first because redemption comes first. On the fourteenth day of the first month, at twilight, each household in Israel killed a lamb chosen days earlier — “an unblemished male a year old” ([Exodus 12:5](#)) — and applied its blood to the doorposts and lintel. That night the Lord passed through Egypt in judgment. What spared a household was not the character of the people inside, the strength of their faith, or the quality of their obedience. It was the blood on the door:

The blood shall be a sign for you on the houses where you live; and when I see the blood I will pass over you, and no plague will befall you to destroy you when I strike the land of Egypt.

— **Exodus 12:13 (NASB95)**

The instructions were precise, and one of them seems almost incidental at first: “nor are you to break any bone of it” ([Exodus 12:46](#)). Israel kept that detail faithfully for centuries without knowing why it mattered.

The Substance

The New Testament answers the “why.” John the Baptist introduced Jesus with a Passover title: “Behold, the Lamb of God who takes away the sin of the world!” ([John 1:29](#)). Jesus was crucified at Passover, during the very season the lambs were being slain ([John 19:14](#); [Mark 14:12](#)). When the soldiers came to break the legs of the crucified men to hasten death, they found Jesus already dead and did not break His — and John tells us plainly that this happened “so that the Scripture would be fulfilled, ‘NOT A BONE OF HIM SHALL BE BROKEN’” ([John 19:36](#)). Paul draws the conclusion without hedging:

Clean out the old leaven so that you may be a new lump, just as you are in fact unleavened. For Christ our Passover also has been sacrificed.

— **1 Corinthians 5:7 (NASB95)**

Peter adds that we were redeemed “with precious blood, as of a lamb unblemished and spotless, the blood of Christ” ([1 Peter 1:19](#)). At the Last Supper — itself a Passover meal — Jesus took the bread and cup of that meal and reinterpreted them around His own body and blood ([Luke 22:19–20](#)).

There is deep assurance in this feast. No Israelite household that night could look at its own record and conclude it was safe; safety rested entirely on whether the blood had been applied. So it is with eternal life. The believer’s security does not rest on how well he has performed since he believed, but on the finished sacrifice of the Lamb, received by faith. God’s promise was not “when I see your worthiness,” but “when I see the blood.”

FOR FURTHER STUDY [Exodus 12:3–11](#) · [Numbers 9:12](#) · [Psalm 34:20](#) · [Isaiah 53:7](#) · [Matthew 26:17–29](#) · [John 1:36](#) · [Revelation 5:6–9](#)

II. Unleavened Bread — The Sinless Body

The Shadow

The Feast of Unleavened Bread began the very next day, the fifteenth of the month, and lasted seven days ([Leviticus 23:6](#)). Every trace of leaven had to be removed from the house ([Exodus 12:15](#)). Historically the feast recalled the haste of the Exodus — Israel left Egypt with dough that had no time to rise ([Exodus 12:34, 39](#)). But throughout Scripture leaven also becomes a picture of something that quietly corrupts and spreads. Jesus warned of “the leaven of the Pharisees and Sadducees,” meaning their teaching ([Matthew 16:6, 12](#)), and Paul twice repeats the proverb, “a little leaven leavens the whole lump” ([1 Corinthians 5:6](#); [Galatians 5:9](#)).

The Substance

Unleavened bread pictures a life without that corruption — which is to say, it pictures the Messiah. He “knew no sin” ([2 Corinthians 5:21](#)); He was tempted in all things “yet without sin” ([Hebrews 4:15](#)). Jesus was buried as this feast began, and His body lay in the tomb during it. Peter, preaching at Pentecost, applied [Psalm 16:10](#) to exactly this: God would not allow His Holy One “TO UNDERGO DECAY” ([Acts 2:27, 31](#)). The sinless body did not see corruption.

Paul then turns the feast toward the believer, and the order of his words matters:

Therefore let us celebrate the feast, not with old leaven, nor with the leaven of malice and wickedness, but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth.

— **1 Corinthians 5:8 (NASB95)**

Notice that in the previous verse he has already told the Corinthians that they *are* unleavened — “just as you are in fact unleavened” ([5:7](#)). He was writing to a church with serious moral problems, yet he described their standing in Christ as already clean. The call to “clean out the old leaven” is not a condition for becoming God’s people; it is an invitation to live out what they already are. This is the distinction between the believer’s position, settled forever by the Passover Lamb, and the believer’s practice, which grows as he walks in the truth. Unleavened Bread follows Passover on the calendar for a reason: the holy walk flows from redemption; it never purchases it.

FOR FURTHER STUDY [Exodus 12:15–20](#) · [Exodus 13:6–8](#) · [Matthew 16:6–12](#) · [Luke 12:1](#) · [John 6:35](#) · [1 Peter 2:22](#)

III. First Fruits — The Risen Lord

The Shadow

When Israel entered the land and began to reap the barley harvest, the first sheaf was not theirs to eat. They brought it to the priest, who waved it before the Lord “for you to be accepted; on the day after the sabbath the priest shall wave it” ([Leviticus 23:10–11](#)). The first sheaf was a token and a pledge: it belonged to God, and its acceptance guaranteed that the rest of the harvest would follow. Until it was offered, no one was to eat of the new crop ([23:14](#)).

Jewish interpreters debated which “sabbath” was meant. The Pharisaic reading took it as the first day of Unleavened Bread, a festival rest day, placing First Fruits on the sixteenth of the month; others, including the Sadducees, took it as the weekly Sabbath, placing First Fruits on a Sunday.^v If the crucifixion fell on Friday the fourteenth, as John’s chronology suggests, the two readings meet: the sixteenth of the month that year was also the first day of the week.

The Substance

On that first day of the week, the women came to the tomb and found it empty ([Matthew 28:1–6](#); [Mark 16:2](#)). The day Israel’s priest lifted the first sheaf before God was the day God raised His Son. Paul does not leave the connection to inference:

But now Christ has been raised from the dead, the first fruits of those who are asleep.

— **1 Corinthians 15:20 (NASB95)**

And then, three verses later, he states what the first sheaf always promised — the harvest follows: “But each in his own order: Christ the first fruits, after that those who are Christ’s at His coming” ([1 Corinthians 15:23](#)). Christ’s resurrection is not an isolated miracle. It is the first installment of the same resurrection every believer will share. Because the first sheaf was accepted, the rest of the harvest is certain.

FOR FURTHER STUDY [Leviticus 23:9–14](#) · [Luke 24:1–7](#) · [John 20:1](#) · [Romans 8:11](#) · [Colossians 1:18](#) · [Revelation 1:5](#)

IV. Pentecost — The Spirit Poured Out

The Shadow

From First Fruits Israel counted seven full weeks — “fifty days to the day after the seventh sabbath” — and then presented a new grain offering ([Leviticus 23:15–16](#)). The name Pentecost comes from the Greek for “fiftieth”; in Hebrew it is *Shavuot*, the Feast of Weeks. It marked the wheat harvest, and it had a startling requirement: the two loaves waved before the Lord were to be “baked with leaven” ([23:17](#)). At every other point the calendar insists on the absence of leaven; here, alone, it is commanded.

Later Jewish tradition also connected Shavuot with the giving of the Law at Sinai, which Exodus places in the third month after the Exodus ([Exodus 19:1](#)).^{vi} Many have noticed the contrast this sets up with Acts 2: when the Law was given, about three thousand died ([Exodus 32:28](#)); when the Spirit was given, about three thousand were brought to life. As Paul puts it, “the letter kills, but the Spirit gives life” ([2 Corinthians 3:6](#)).

The Substance

Jesus told His disciples to wait in Jerusalem for “what the Father had promised” ([Acts 1:4–5](#)). They did not wait long past the counting of the fifty days:

When the day of Pentecost had come, they were all together in one place. And suddenly there came from heaven a noise like a violent rushing wind, and it filled the whole house where they were sitting.

— [Acts 2:1–2 \(NASB95\)](#)

That day “there were added about three thousand souls” ([Acts 2:41](#)). The first sheaf at First Fruits was one resurrected Man; the harvest at Pentecost was a body of people. Dispensational theology has consistently identified this day as the birth of the church, because it is the first occasion of the baptizing work of the Spirit that Paul describes: “For by one Spirit we were all baptized into one body, whether Jews or Greeks” ([1 Corinthians 12:13](#)).^{vii}

This may also explain the leavened loaves. The Passover Lamb and the First Fruits sheaf picture Christ Himself, who is without sin; the Pentecost loaves picture His people, who are not. Many dispensational teachers see in the *two* loaves a hint of the two groups the Spirit would join into one body — Jew and Gentile, made “one new man” ([Ephesians 2:14–16](#)). The offering was accepted with the leaven still in it, because it was presented along with the sacrifices ([Leviticus 23:18](#)). So are we.

FOR FURTHER STUDY [Joel 2:28–29](#) · [John 7:39](#) · [John 14:16–17](#) · [Acts 1:8](#) · [Acts 2:16–18](#) · [Acts 11:15–16](#) · [Ephesians 1:13–14](#)

The Long Summer — The Present Age

After Pentecost, Israel's calendar goes quiet. There is no appointed feast for roughly four months while the harvest is gathered in the fields. Then, in the seventh month, three feasts come in close succession. If the spring feasts were fulfilled with remarkable precision at Christ's first coming, the long gap before the fall feasts corresponds naturally to the present age — the time between His first and second comings, when the Spirit is gathering a harvest from every nation.

Leviticus 23 itself hints at this. Between the instructions for Pentecost and those for Trumpets, a single verse interrupts the feast list with a harvest law: "When you reap the harvest of your land, moreover, you shall not reap to the very corners of your field nor gather the gleaning of your harvest; you are to leave them for the needy and the alien" ([Leviticus 23:22](#)). The one command placed in the gap is a provision for outsiders gathering grain in Israel's field. It is a fitting picture of an age in which Gentiles are being brought in while "a partial hardening has happened to Israel until the fullness of the Gentiles has come in" ([Romans 11:25](#)).

Dispensational theology has long distinguished God's program for the church in this age from His unfinished program for the nation of Israel.^{viii} The feast calendar fits that distinction well. The spring feasts are finished; the summer harvest is underway; and the fall feasts — Trumpets, Atonement, Tabernacles — are still waiting on the calendar.

FOR FURTHER STUDY [Luke 21:24](#) · [Acts 15:14–16](#) · [Romans 11:11–27](#) · [Ephesians 3:4–6](#) · [Matthew 9:37–38](#)

V. Trumpets — The Gathering Call

The Shadow

The seventh month opened with a day of rest and “a reminder by blowing of trumpets, a holy convocation” ([Leviticus 23:24](#)). Scripture gives this feast less explanation than any other. In Israel, trumpets summoned the congregation, signaled that the camp was to move, and sounded the alarm for war ([Numbers 10:1–10](#)). The Feast of Trumpets called Israel to attention because the most solemn day of the year, the Day of Atonement, was ten days away. In later Judaism the day became *Rosh Hashanah*, the civil New Year.

The Substance — Anticipated

The New Testament never says in so many words, “this fulfills the Feast of Trumpets.” But it repeatedly attaches a trumpet blast to the gathering of God’s people at the end of the age. For the church:

For the Lord Himself will descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel and with the trumpet of God, and the dead in Christ will rise first. Then we who are alive and remain will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air, and so we shall always be with the Lord.

— **1 Thessalonians 4:16–17 (NASB95)**

Paul says the same in [1 Corinthians 15:52](#): “in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet.” For Israel, the prophets and Jesus Himself link a “great trumpet” to the regathering of the scattered nation ([Isaiah 27:13](#); [Matthew 24:31](#)). Interpreters within the dispensational camp differ on whether Trumpets pictures primarily the rapture of the church or primarily Israel’s regathering at the Messiah’s return; both are gatherings, and both are announced by a trumpet.

One caution belongs here. Because Passover, First Fruits, and Pentecost were fulfilled on their calendar days, some have tried to predict the date of the rapture by the date of Rosh Hashanah. Scripture closes that door. Jesus said, “of that day and hour no one knows” ([Matthew 24:36](#)), and He told the apostles, “It is not for you to know times or epochs” ([Acts 1:7](#)). Pretribulational writers have stressed that the rapture is imminent — it could occur at any moment, with no sign or date that must precede it.^{ix} The Feast of Trumpets tells us *what* is coming, not *when*. Its message to the believer is the one Paul drew from it: “Therefore comfort one another with these words” ([1 Thessalonians 4:18](#)).

FOR FURTHER STUDY [Numbers 29:1](#) · [Joel 2:1](#) · [Zechariah 9:14](#) · [1 Corinthians 15:51](#) · [Titus 2:13](#) · [Revelation 11:15](#)

VI. The Day of Atonement — The Nation Cleansed

The Shadow

Ten days after Trumpets came the holiest day of Israel's year: "On exactly the tenth day of this seventh month is the day of atonement; it shall be a holy convocation for you, and you shall humble your souls" ([Leviticus 23:27](#)). The full ritual is given in [Leviticus 16](#). Once a year the high priest passed behind the veil into the Holy of Holies with the blood of a sacrifice and sprinkled it on the mercy seat; a second goat, the scapegoat, carried the nation's sins away into the wilderness. It was the only day Israel was commanded to fast.

This day remains deeply meaningful in Jewish life, though no temple or high priest has existed since AD 70. In the most recent major survey of American Jews, 46 percent said they had fasted for all or part of the previous Yom Kippur, and about six in ten had held or attended a Passover Seder.^x For many Jewish neighbors, these appointed times are still the most familiar points of contact with the Scriptures — which makes them natural, respectful starting points for conversation about the Messiah they point to.

The Substance — Accomplished

The Book of Hebrews reads the Day of Atonement as fulfilled in Christ's single, finished work. The high priest entered an earthly sanctuary every year with the blood of animals; Christ entered heaven itself once, with His own blood:

But when Christ appeared as a high priest of the good things to come, He entered through the greater and more perfect tabernacle, not made with hands, that is to say, not of this creation; and not through the blood of goats and calves, but through His own blood, He entered the holy place once for all, having obtained eternal redemption.

— [Hebrews 9:11–12 \(NASB95\)](#)

The contrast is not merely between two sacrifices but between two postures. The Levitical priest "stands daily ministering and offering time after time the same sacrifices, which can never take away sins; but He, having offered one sacrifice for sins for all time, SAT DOWN AT THE RIGHT HAND OF GOD" ([Hebrews 10:11–12](#)). A seated priest is a finished work.^{xi} Hebrews then states the result in words every anxious believer should know by heart: "For by one offering He has perfected for all time those who are sanctified" ([Hebrews 10:14](#)). The redemption He obtained is called "eternal" ([9:12](#)) — not provisional, not renewable each year, not dependent on the recipient's later performance.

The Substance — Anticipated

Yet the Day of Atonement also carried a national dimension: the whole people of Israel humbled their souls together. That, too, has a future fulfillment. Zechariah describes a day when the nation as a whole will recognize the One it rejected:

I will pour out on the house of David and on the inhabitants of Jerusalem, the Spirit of grace and of supplication, so that they will look on Me whom they have pierced; and they will mourn for Him, as one mourns for an only son, and they will weep bitterly over Him like the bitter weeping over a firstborn.

— **Zechariah 12:10 (NASB95)**

Paul anticipates the same day: “and so all Israel will be saved” ([Romans 11:26](#)). Dispensational interpreters see this national repentance at the Messiah’s return as the prophetic fulfillment of Israel’s great day of affliction of soul.^{xii} The atonement itself was completed at the cross; what remains is for the nation to look upon Him and receive it.

FOR FURTHER STUDY [Leviticus 16:15–22](#) · [Isaiah 53:4–6](#) · [Romans 3:25](#) · [Hebrews 9:24–28](#) · [Hebrews 10:19–22](#) · [Zechariah 13:1](#) · [Revelation 1:7](#)

VII. Tabernacles — God Dwelling with His People

The Shadow

Five days after the Day of Atonement came the most joyful feast of the year. For seven days Israel lived in booths made of branches, “so that your generations may know that I had the sons of Israel live in booths when I brought them out from the land of Egypt” ([Leviticus 23:42–43](#)). It was also the great harvest festival, kept “when you have gathered in the crops of the land” ([23:39](#)), with an eighth day of assembly at its close. Its theme was God’s care for His people in the wilderness, and God dwelling in their midst.

By the time of Jesus, two ceremonies had been added. Each morning a priest drew water from the Pool of Siloam and poured it out at the altar while the people sang; the Mishnah says that whoever had not seen the rejoicing at this water-drawing had never seen rejoicing in his life. Each evening, great golden lampstands were lit in the Court of the Women, and their light was said to illuminate every courtyard in Jerusalem.^{xliixiv}

The Substance — Foreshadowed

John’s Gospel opens with Tabernacles language: “And the Word became flesh, and dwelt among us” ([John 1:14](#)). The verb John chose, *skēnoō*, means to pitch a tent or to tabernacle.^{xv} The God who once dwelt with Israel in a tent in the wilderness came to dwell among His people in a human body.

Then, in the middle of this very feast ([John 7:2](#)), Jesus used both of its ceremonies to describe Himself. On the last day, while the water-pouring still rang in the people’s ears:

Now on the last day, the great day of the feast, Jesus stood and cried out, saying, “If anyone is thirsty, let him come to Me and drink. He who believes in Me, as the Scripture said, ‘From his innermost being will flow rivers of living water.’”

— **John 7:37–38 (NASB95)**

John explains that He was speaking of the Spirit, who would be given after He was glorified ([John 7:39](#)). And in the shadow of the great lampstands, He declared, “I am the Light of the world; he who follows Me will not walk in the darkness, but will have the Light of life” ([John 8:12](#)). The invitation He gave at Tabernacles has no qualifications attached: “if *anyone* is thirsty.” The only condition is to come and drink — to believe in Him.

The Substance — Anticipated

Tabernacles is also the one feast the prophets say the nations themselves will keep. After the Lord returns and becomes “king over all the earth” ([Zechariah 14:9](#)), Zechariah writes:

Then it will come about that any who are left of all the nations that went against Jerusalem will go up from year to year to worship the King, the LORD of hosts, and to celebrate the Feast of Booths.

— **Zechariah 14:16 (NASB95)**

This is the harvest feast of the kingdom. Its final echo comes at the very end of the Bible: “Behold, the tabernacle of God is among men, and He will dwell among them, and they shall

be His people” ([Revelation 21:3](#)). What the booths in the wilderness pictured, and what the incarnation began, the kingdom and the eternal state will complete.

FOR FURTHER STUDY [Exodus 25:8](#) · [Nehemiah 8:14–17](#) · [Isaiah 12:3](#) · [Isaiah 9:2](#) · [Matthew 17:4](#) · [John 4:14](#)
· [Revelation 7:9–17](#)

The Seven Feasts at a Glance

The table below gathers the seven appointed times of Leviticus 23, their place in Israel's calendar, and the New Testament fulfillment each one points to.

Feast	Leviticus 23	Timing	Fulfillment in Christ	Status
Passover (Pesach)	vv. 4–5	1st month, 14th day	Christ our Passover sacrificed (1 Cor. 5:7)	Fulfilled — first coming
Unleavened Bread (Hag HaMatzot)	vv. 6–8	1st month, 15th–21st	The sinless One laid in the tomb; believers declared “unleavened” (1 Cor. 5:7–8)	Fulfilled — first coming
First Fruits (Bikkurim)	vv. 9–14	“Day after the sabbath”	Christ raised, “the first fruits of those who are asleep” (1 Cor. 15:20)	Fulfilled — first coming
Pentecost (Shavuot)	vv. 15–22	Fifty days after First Fruits	The Spirit poured out; the church formed (Acts 2:1–4)	Fulfilled — first coming
Trumpets (Yom Teruah)	vv. 23–25	7th month, 1st day	The trumpet of gathering (1 Thess. 4:16 ; Matt. 24:31)	Anticipated — second coming
Day of Atonement (Yom Kippur)	vv. 26–32	7th month, 10th day	Atonement finished once for all (Heb. 9:12); Israel's national repentance (Zech. 12:10)	Accomplished; its national fruit anticipated
Tabernacles (Sukkot)	vv. 33–43	7th month, 15th–21st, plus 8th day	The Word “dwelt” among us (John 1:14); the nations keep the feast in the kingdom (Zech. 14:16)	Foreshadowed; anticipated — kingdom

A note on Hanukkah. John records that Jesus was also in Jerusalem at “the Feast of the Dedication” ([John 10:22](#)), which commemorated the rededication of the temple in 164 BC. It is not one of the seven appointed times of Leviticus 23, but it is where Jesus said, “I and the Father are one” ([John 10:30](#)) — a fitting claim to make at a festival about God's true dwelling place.

Conclusion: Shadow and Substance

Read as a whole, Leviticus 23 is the gospel in calendar form. It begins with a slain lamb whose blood alone shields from judgment. It continues with a sinless life laid in the tomb, a first sheaf lifted up on the first day of the week, and a harvest gathered by the Spirit fifty days later. It pauses through a long summer in which outsiders glean in Israel's field. And it ends with a trumpet, a nation's repentance, and God living among His people in joy.

Notice where the calendar begins. It does not open with the Day of Atonement's call to "humble your souls," or with the harvest labor of Tabernacles. It opens with Passover — with what God provides and the sinner receives. Everything else on the calendar flows from that first night in Egypt. So it is in the Christian life. Eternal life is received as a gift, by faith alone in Christ alone, at the moment one believes; the walk of an "unleavened" life, the fruit of the Spirit, and the reward of the kingdom all follow from that gift and never secure it.

For the believer, the fulfilled feasts are a foundation that cannot move: the Lamb has been slain, the atonement is finished, the First Fruits has been raised, and the Spirit has been given as a seal. The unfulfilled feasts are a hope that cannot fail: the trumpet will sound, Israel will look on the One they pierced, and God will dwell with His people forever. The shadows were accurate. The substance belongs to Christ.

And the invitation Jesus gave on the great day of the feast still stands, unchanged and unconditional: "If anyone is thirsty, let him come to Me and drink."

Lord, thank You.

ⁱNew American Standard Bible, 1995 edition (La Habra, CA: The Lockman Foundation, 1995). Unless otherwise noted, all Scripture quotations are from the NASB 1995. Scripture references throughout are hyperlinked to Blue Letter Bible.

ⁱⁱArnold G. Fruchtenbaum, *The Feasts and Fasts of Israel: Their Historic and Prophetic Significance*, ed. Christiane K. Jurik (San Antonio: Ariel Ministries, 2019). Fruchtenbaum treats each feast under its Mosaic observance, its later rabbinic observance, and its Messianic fulfillment — the most thorough dispensational treatment available.

ⁱⁱⁱKevin Howard and Marvin Rosenthal, *The Feasts of the Lord: God's Prophetic Calendar from Calvary to the Kingdom* (Nashville: Thomas Nelson, 1997). Written from a Hebrew Christian perspective, this volume popularized the spring-fulfilled / fall-anticipated reading of the calendar.

^{iv}A covenant-theology alternative is noted here but not adopted: many Reformed interpreters read all of the feasts as fulfilled in Christ and His church, without a distinct future program for national Israel in which the fall feasts find a literal fulfillment. See Michael Horton, *The Christian Faith: A Systematic Theology for Pilgrims on the Way* (Grand Rapids: Zondervan, 2011), on the typological fulfillment of the Mosaic institutions in Christ.

^vThe dispute is recorded in the Babylonian Talmud, Menachot 65a–66a; see Isidore Epstein, ed., *The Babylonian Talmud* (London: Soncino Press, 1935–1948). For its bearing on the resurrection chronology, see Fruchtenbaum, *Feasts and Fasts of Israel*, on the Feast of First Fruits.

^{vi}Babylonian Talmud, Pesachim 68b, where Shavuot is called “the day on which the Torah was given”; Epstein, ed., *The Babylonian Talmud*.

^{vii}Charles C. Ryrie, *Basic Theology* (Chicago: Moody Press, 1999), in his discussion of the beginning of the church and the baptizing ministry of the Holy Spirit.

^{viii}J. Dwight Pentecost, *Things to Come: A Study in Biblical Eschatology* (Grand Rapids: Zondervan, 1958), on the distinction between God's program for the church and His program for Israel, and on the church age as an unforeseen interval in Israel's prophetic program.

^{ix}John F. Walvoord, *The Rapture Question*, rev. and enl. ed. (Grand Rapids: Zondervan, 1979), on the imminence of the rapture.

^xPew Research Center, “Jewish Americans in 2020,” ch. 3, “Jewish Practices and Customs,” May 11, 2021, <https://www.pewresearch.org/religion/2021/05/11/jewish-practices-and-customs/>. Cited for cultural context only; not a doctrinal source.

^{xi}John F. Walvoord and Roy B. Zuck, eds., *The Bible Knowledge Commentary: New Testament* (Wheaton, IL: Victor Books, 1983), on Hebrews 9:11–10:18.

^{xii}Pentecost, *Things to Come*, on the future conversion and restoration of Israel at the second advent.

^{xiii}Mishnah Sukkah 4:9 and 5:1–4, in Herbert Danby, trans., *The Mishnah* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1933).

^{xiv}Alfred Edersheim, *The Temple: Its Ministry and Services as They Were at the Time of Jesus Christ* (London: Religious Tract Society, 1874), ch. 14, “The Feast of Tabernacles.” Edersheim notes that the water-pouring and the illumination were understood as related symbols, the light recalling the Shekinah and the “great light” of Isaiah 9:2.

^{xv}Joseph Henry Thayer, *A Greek-English Lexicon of the New Testament* (New York: American Book Company, 1889), s.v. “σκηνώ” (Strong's G4637): “to fix one's tabernacle, have one's tabernacle, abide (or live) in a tabernacle (or tent).”